We will implement the attached study design using the attached implementation plan, one unit at a time.

I am a beginner in research programming and will manually transfer your code to a local Git-controlled project.

Follow these rules throughout our conversation:

One unit at a time. Implement only the unit I request. Do not proceed to subsequent units without permission.

Minimal code. Prefer simple, readable solutions. Avoid unnecessary complexity and dependencies.

Easy file transfer. Specify filenames and locations. Provide complete code for new files and minimal, clearly located changes for existing files. Do not rewrite unrelated content.

Explain the code. Briefly explain what it does and how to run it. Ask for existing code or missing information when needed.

Separate implementation and verification. When I request implementation, generate only implementation code and basic running instructions. When I request verification, provide independent checks against the original unit requirements.

Respect approved decisions. Do not silently modify the study design, implementation plan, or previously approved code.

Do not assume success. You cannot access my local files or run the code. Wait for me to report results before proceeding.

Keep responses concise and beginner-friendly.

Wait for me to specify the first unit.

Understood. I'll wait for you to specify the first unit. I'll implement only that unit, then pause for you to run it and report back before we continue.

Implement Unit 1.1.

Unit 1.1 — Repository folders and Git exclusions

The plan calls for these project folders and a `.gitignore` that protects raw and processed data while leaving scripts, documentation, and permitted aggregate results trackable.

1. Create the folders

From your repository's root folder, run this in the R console:

r

```r
folders <- c(
  "data/raw",
  "data/processed",
  "scripts",
  "results",
  "docs"
)

for (folder in folders) {
  dir.create(folder, recursive = TRUE, showWarnings = FALSE)
}
```

2. Create `.gitignore`

Create a file named `.gitignore` in the repository root and add:

gitignore

```
# Raw source files and work-level derived data
/data/raw/
/data/processed/

# R session and local project files
.Rhistory
.RData
.Ruserdata
.Rproj.user/
.Renviron
.Rprofile.local
```

```
# Temporary files and logs
*.tmp
*.temp
*.swp
*~
*.log

# Common operating-system files
.DS_Store
Thumbs.db
```

The R code creates the folders if they don't already exist. The ignore rules protect data and common local files; they do not ignore `scripts/`, `docs/`, or `results/`. Git does not track empty folders, so they'll appear in Git once they contain files.

Help me verify Unit 1.1 against its original requirements, if any.

Unit 1.1 verification

The original requirements are to create the planned folders, ignore raw and processed data plus local temporary/configuration/log files, and keep scripts, documentation, and permitted aggregate results trackable. The plan specifically calls for testing protected data paths and confirming a README or script remains trackable.

I can't inspect your local repository, so please run these checks from the repository root and share the output.

1. Check that folders exist

In RStudio, run:

r

```r
required_folders <- c(
  "data/raw",
  "data/processed",
  "scripts",
  "results",
  "docs"
)
```

```
missing_folders <- required_folders[!dir.exists(required_folders)]

if (length(missing_folders) == 0) {
  cat("PASS: all required folders exist.\n")
} else {
  cat("FAIL: missing folders:", paste(missing_folders, collapse = ", "),
"\n")
}
```

2. Create temporary test files

Run this in R:

r

```
test_files <- c(
  "data/raw/unit_1_1_test.txt",
  "data/processed/unit_1_1_test.txt",
  "scripts/unit_1_1_test.R"
)

for (file in test_files) {
  writeLines("temporary verification file", file)
}
```

3. Check Git's treatment of the test files

In your RStudio Terminal, run:

sh

```
git status --short --ignored -- data/raw/unit_1_1_test.txt
data/processed/unit_1_1_test.txt scripts/unit_1_1_test.R
```

Expected: the two data files show `!!` (ignored), and the script shows `??` (untracked but available to add to Git). If either data file shows `??`, it is not being ignored.

4. Remove the temporary files

Back in R, run:

r

```
unlink(test_files)
```

Pass criteria: all five folders exist; the raw and processed test files are ignored; and the test script is not ignored. If any check fails, send me the command output and your `.gitignore` contents.

Unit 1.1 produced this verification error. Explain it and suggest the smallest correction:

> git status --short --ignored -- data/raw/unit_1_1_test.txt data/processed/unit_1_1_test.txt scripts/unit_1_1_test.R
Error: unexpected symbol in "git status"

That error means the Git command was entered in the R Console, where R tried to interpret `git status` as R code. It's a shell command, not R code.

Smallest correction: run the same command in RStudio's Terminal tab (from your repository root), not the Console:

```sh
git status --short --ignored -- data/raw/unit_1_1_test.txt data/processed/unit_1_1_test.txt scripts/unit_1_1_test.R
```

The folder-check and file-creation snippets belong in the R Console; this Git command belongs in the Terminal.

Unit 1.1. verified. Implement Unit 1.2.

Searched the internet"Find official source/access page and acquisition instructions for "SODA Open Research Teaching Data" release 1.0.0. Determine whether this appears to be a real dataset and give only verified official links/citations, or say not found. Do not infer."

According to the internet search agent: No official access page or acquisition instructions for "SODA Open Research Teaching Data" release 1.0.0 could be found. None of the results provide verified, official links or confirm the existence of this dataset. No evidence was found from recognized institutional, academic, or governmental sources.

Unit 1.2 requires a `README.md` data-acquisition section with provenance fields, without inventing unverified details.Since I couldn't verify an official access route, the README below explicitly marks it for confirmation.

File: `README.md`

If you already have a README, append this section rather than replacing its contents. If not, create `README.md` in the project root with this text:

markdown

```
# SODA Open Research Teaching Data analysis

## Data acquisition and provenance

### Dataset and access

The intended dataset is the SODA Open Research Teaching Data, release
1.0.0, as specified in the study design.

**Official source and access instructions:** To be confirmed from the
official dataset documentation or the project lead. The access route has
not yet been verified. Do not guess a URL or use an unverified download
source.

After confirming the official source and obtaining the release:

1. Keep the original downloaded files unchanged.
2. Place them locally in `data/raw/`.
3. Record the provenance details below. Do not assume the data are included
in this Git repository.

### Provenance details to record

- **Retrieval date:** Record the date the files were obtained.
- **Release/version:** 1.0.0; confirm this against the obtained release.
- **Official source URL or citation:** To be added after verification.
- **Original filenames:** Record the exact filenames received.
- **Documented snapshot date(s):** Record these if stated in the official
documentation; otherwise record "not documented."

### Data handling

Do not commit raw source files, work-level records, or abstract text to
Git. Do not paste or send raw records or abstracts to AI tools.
```

Save the file in the repository root. There is no code to run for this documentation unit; leave the marked details unresolved until you can confirm them from an official source.

> Help me verify Unit 1.2 against its original requirements, if any.

Unit 1.2 verification checklist

The original requirements are for a `README.md` data-acquisition section that identifies the dataset/version, documents how to obtain and place the files locally, lists provenance details, avoids invented information, and states the data-handling restrictions.

Check the section you added:

- Dataset and release: It names *SODA Open Research Teaching Data* and release 1.0.0.
- Access route: It either gives a verified official source or clearly says the official route is still to be confirmed. It must not invent a URL or filename. The search in our earlier exchange did not find a verified official access page.
- Local placement: It says to keep original files unchanged and put them under `data/raw/`; it does not suggest the data are included in Git.
- Provenance fields: It asks you to record retrieval date, release/version, official source URL or citation, exact original filenames, and documented snapshot date(s), noting when a snapshot date is not documented.
- Data handling: It says not to commit raw source/work-level data or abstract text, and not to send records or abstracts to AI tools.

Pass: Each item is present, and any unverified source detail is clearly marked as unconfirmed.
Fail: The README contains an invented URL or filename, implies the data are bundled in the repository, or instructs you to commit raw records or abstracts.

I can check the section directly if you paste its text here; don’t include any dataset records or abstracts.